Jose Antonio Elizalde

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Education

University of California, Los Angeles **Sep 2025 – June 2027**
B.S. in Computer Science and Engineering – GPA: 3.5 *Los Angeles, CA*

Los Angeles Pierce College **Feb 2023 – June 2025**
A.A. in Mathematics and Physics – GPA: 4.0 *Woodland Hills, CA*

Research Experience

Carnegie Mellon University – REUSE Research Program **May 2025 – Aug 2025**
Undergraduate Researcher, Human-Computer Interaction Institute (HCII) *Pittsburgh, PA*

- Built an interactive application studying whether gamified in-ride interactions can improve communication and empathy between rideshare drivers and passengers, refining its features based on **usability testing across nine workshops**.
- Co-authored ***Beyond Riding:*** *Passenger Engagement with Driver Labor through Gamified Interactions*, accepted to **CHI 2026** (ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems, Barcelona).

Game Projects

Jump the Gun | ***Unity, C#, Git*** **– Game Director | UCLA ACM Studio** **Oct 2025 – Present**

- Direct a team of **8** programmers and artists on a single-player **first-person action shooter** about a father hunting down the mob boss who kidnapped his daughter, defining the core **gameplay mechanics** and coordinating work across programming and art through GitHub branching, code reviews, and weekly team meetings.
- Wrote a custom **physics-based movement controller** in **C#**, replacing **Unity**'s built-in character controller with hand-written movement and **collision logic** to give the game its own feel instead of the engine default.

U.F. ZOO | ***Unity, C#, Blender*** **– Gameplay Programmer, team of 20** **Aug 2026 – Present**

- Build **gameplay systems** for a city-builder/deck-builder roguelike tycoon in which players build a zoo in the sky and clear point quotas, targeting a **Steam release in January 2027**.
- Implemented the **card ability system**, covering **15+ distinct card effects** and their resolution rules, plus the **multi-island expansion** feature that lets players grow their zoo outward.

Smithing Game | ***Unity, C#, Shaders*** **– Gameplay Programmer, team of 6** **Oct 2026**

- Built a 3D first-person **blacksmithing game** for **Ludum Dare 60** in which players hammer a hot ingot and cut it with scissors to craft whatever the prompt asks for.
- Implemented the **player movement**, **hammer swing and hit mechanics**, and ingot grabbing, integrating them with a teammate's **3D mesh deformation** so each strike visibly reshapes the metal.
- Created a **hot-ingot shader** that makes the metal glow red-hot, along with **particle effects** that spray sparks from the ingot each time it is struck.

Shellscape | ***Unity, C#, WebGL*** **– Gameplay Programmer, team of 5** **Aug 2026**

- Shipped a browser-playable action game for **Club Club Jam Jam 2026**, in which the player is a ghost-like figure who possesses security guards to escape an evil lab; placed **74th of roughly 150 teams** and released publicly on **itch.io**.
- Implemented the **movement and interaction systems**, including the **body-possession mechanic** the whole game is built around: the player has no body of their own and takes over enemies to use their weapons.

One Tap Cook | ***Unity, C#, WebGL*** **– Gameplay Programmer, team of 5** **Nov 2025**

- Built a game around **career-ladder progression**, in which the player rises from a fast-food line to a Michelin-star kitchen and each round is a timed minigame.
- Designed and implemented **two of the game's minigames**, Wheel of Death and a rhythm-tap sequence, along with the full **UI/UX**, music, and **sound effects**.

Extracurriculars

UCLA ACM Studio – Intern **Sep 2025 – Present**

- Help run workshops that teach new and returning members game development topics such as building a roguelike from scratch and 3D modeling.
- Help organize the club's internal **game jams**, form teams for external jams, and answer members' technical and logistical questions throughout.

Technical Skills

Languages: C#, C++, C, Python, GLSL, TypeScript, Bash
Engines & Graphics: Unity, Unreal, Godot, Three.js/WebGL, Blender (3D modeling)
Game Development: Gameplay systems, physics-based character controllers, shaders & particle effects, UI/UX, WebGL
Tools: Git/GitHub, Visual Studio, Neovim, Linux
Relevant Coursework: Computer Graphics, Operating Systems, Algorithms & Complexity, Software Construction, Programming Languages, Data Structures & Algorithms, Computer Architecture, Discrete Mathematics, Physics